

Gender Identity-Relevant Responses to Threats Against Racial Status Quo



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Introduction

Prior research has shown White Americans perceive less racism than Black Americans and conceive of racism as interpersonal rather than systemic as an identity-defensive response (Omar, 2023; Carter & Murphy, 2015).

Research Question

Do identity-relevant perceptions of racism extend to the domain of gender?

Method

Sample

- Cloud Connect: White and Black American men and women (N = 340)
- Age: $M = 41$, $SD = 12.02$
- Political ID: $M = -0.34$ (slightly liberal)

Perception Measures

- 7-point scale: 1 (Not at all due to racism/sexism) to 7 (Certainly due to racism/sexism)

Interpersonal Racism (6 items)

- Black Target: A group of three African American friends were waiting for a table at a restaurant. While they waited, two other groups of similar size arrived and were seated before them.

Systemic Racism (8 items)

- White target: Affirmative action policies that promote hiring and retention of people from underrepresented ethnic minority groups.

Interpersonal Sexism (6 items)

- Male target: A person on a walk notices a man on a street corner. They cross to the other side of the street and continue walking.

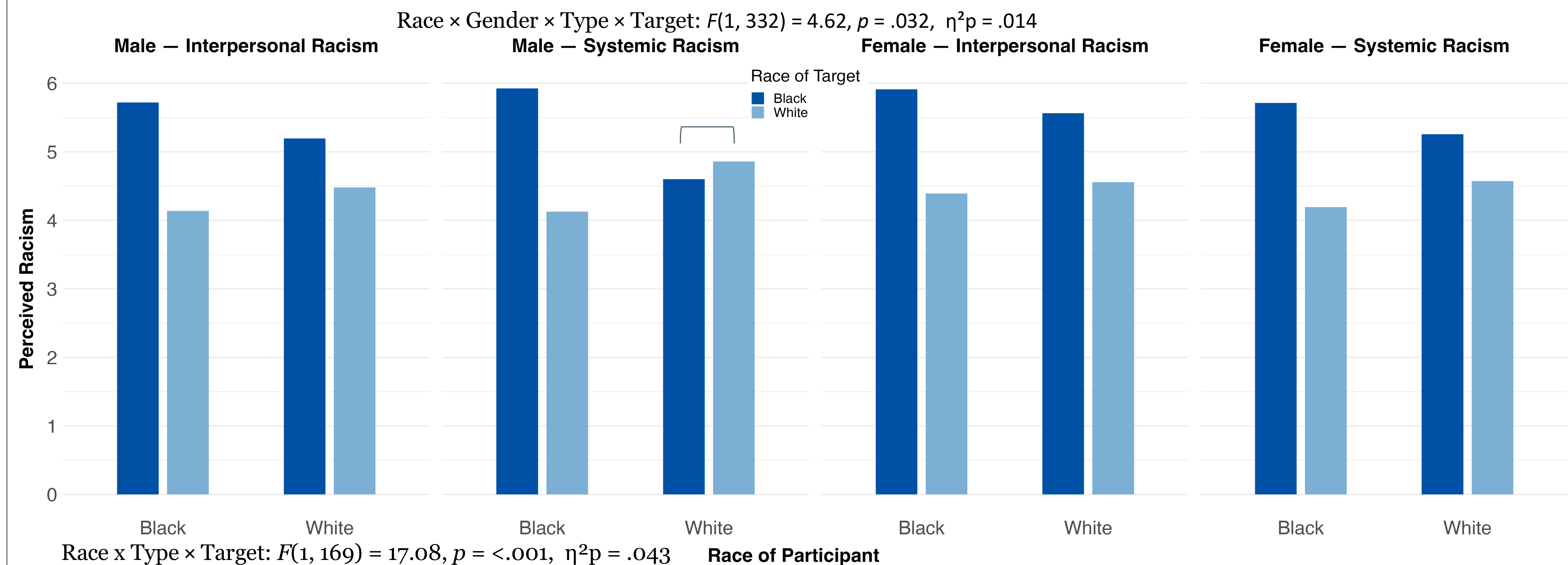
Systemic Sexism (6 items)

- Female target: In the United States, 1 in 3 women experience physical or sexual violence in their lifetime.

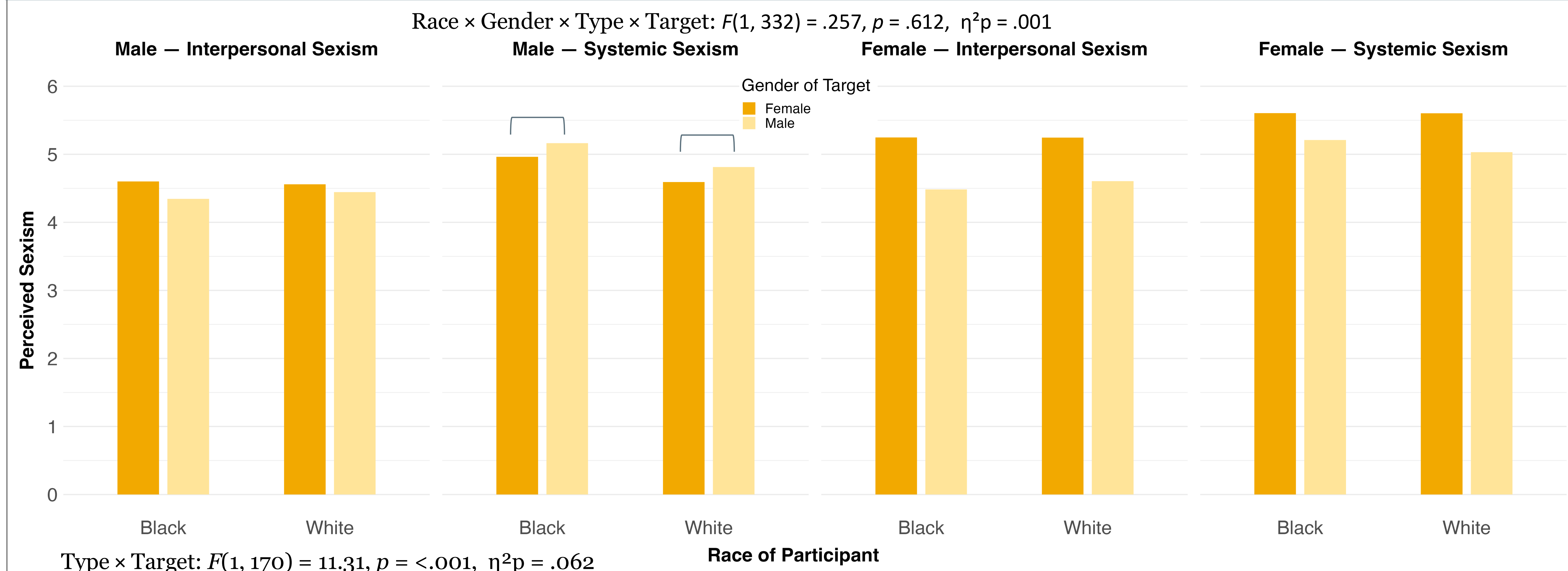
Discussion

Perceptions of systemic prejudice are identity-relevant: dominant group members perceive more structural discrimination toward their own group, while marginalized group members perceive more discrimination overall.

Racism Perceptions: White men reverse the typical pattern, perceiving more systemic racism toward White targets.



Sexism Perceptions: Men reverse the typical pattern, perceiving more systemic sexism toward male targets.



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